

10-minute mini-lessons

This is a short one that explicitly teaches students new words that can be used in place of “go against” in their analytic writing.

Engage (1 minute)	Learning intention: to understand the nuance of different words. Create a table on the whiteboard with the following headings: <i>What are the positives and negatives of using an online thesaurus?</i> <table border="1" data-bbox="518 488 1121 645"><thead><tr><th>Positives</th><th>Negatives</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td> </td><td> </td></tr></tbody></table> Students quickly grab a whiteboard marker and add one idea to the table.	Positives	Negatives		
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New information (2 minutes)	Explain: <i>We have many words for similar ideas because each often carries a subtle but specific difference.</i> <i>We might say that these differences are nuanced, or subtle.</i> <i>The noun nuance can mean “a subtle difference or distinction”.</i> <i>For example:</i> <i>The word “tension” means “stretched”.</i> <i>A thesaurus shows us that synonyms include “pressure”, “strain” and “stress”.</i> <i>Which of those synonyms would make sense in the following sentence?</i> <i>In English, there is a sense of _____ created when two ideas pull against each other.</i>				
Activity (5 minutes)	The following words are all synonyms of the awful phrase “go against”. But they are not strictly synonymous. See if you can create a definition for three of the following words that captures the nuance of each. • Defy • Deny • Oppose • Challenge • Contradict • Dispute • Deviate				
Reflect (2 minute)	What are some strategies you can put into place to make sure that you use nuanced words correctly?				